



MONASH University

# Assessment 1: Part 2

Faculty of Information Technology

FIT5125 / FIT4005

IT Research and Innovation Methods

Semester 2, 2025

## Assignment 1: Part 2

### Topic

Tasks related to material in Weeks 1-6.

### Value

This assignment is worth **45%** of the total marks for FIT5125/FIT4005.

### Assignment due date

**Friday, 19 September 2025 (Week 8) at 11:55 PM (Australian Eastern Time)**

***Note:** there is also a deadline, **11:55 PM Tuesday 9 September (AET), for Task C**, by which time you must register two times/dates when you are available to be interviewed by another student.*

### Submission method

Submit the following in Moodle:

- Excel Workbooks, using the provided templates, for each of Tasks A, B, and C.
- An audio file (MP3 or MP4 format) of your interview for Task C.
- A completed interview consent form (PDF) for Task C.

## Assignment Criteria: Part 1 and Part 2

| Pre-tasks<br>Study Participation | Task A<br>Research Ethics | Task B<br>Literature Search | Task C<br>Interview |
|----------------------------------|---------------------------|-----------------------------|---------------------|
| Weighting 5%                     | Weighting: 30%            | Weighting: 30%              | Weighting: 35%      |
| See Part 1                       | See Page 3.               | See Page 4.                 | See Page 5.         |

This is an individual assessment; it must be your own work and expressed in your own words.

☞ *A marking guide is available on Moodle.*

☞ *There are specific requirements for file names on your submission.*

### Assessment rules:

1. Note that plagiarism detection procedures may be applied to each submission. See the University rules and regulations regarding plagiarism and resulting penalties. Any case of plagiarism detected will result in the automatic failure of the entire assignment.
2. Late submissions will incur a penalty of 5% per day, see:  
<https://publicpolicydms.monash.edu/Monash/documents/1935752>
3. Monash policy on Special Consideration is available at:  
<https://www.monash.edu/exams/changes/special-consideration>
4. Due to the size of the unit (over 1000 students) and the nature of the assignment, we aim to mark and return work within **15 working days** of submission (i.e. **10 October 2025**).
5. AI tools (e.g., ChatGPT) **are permitted** for this assignment, and there is **no requirement** to include a statement regarding their use.

### IMPORTANT

- If you have any **questions** about the assignment, you should submit them as a public post to the **Ed forum** (under the sub-category “Assignments”) so that all students have access to your question and the Chief Examiner’s or Unit Coordinator’s response.
- This is an **individual assignment** that forms part of the formal assessment for the unit; you must therefore work alone and follow Monash University’s policies, procedures and regulations relating to academic integrity, plagiarism and collusion.
- This is a **formal assessment**, so tutors are not permitted to provide direct support to you. However, they can provide feedback on related studio activities (during a studio).
- This assignment aims to evaluate your understanding of research ethics, literature reviews, and the planning and conduct of interview-based qualitative research.

## Task A (Week 2)

### “Identifying and Mitigating Ethical Concerns”

Understanding research ethics is crucial for conducting responsible research, especially when human participants are involved. This task aims to evaluate your ability to review the ethical requirements of a research project. It requires you to provide thoughtful, well-reasoned responses to typical questions posed by a Human Research Ethics Committee.

Based on your experience of participating in the Kluster Networking Challenge:

1. Review the ethics application form (and attachments) for a version of the study similar to the one you participated in: <https://tinyurl.com/KLUSTER-S2-2025>
2. Consider the following **three research projects**. Each focuses on **evaluating Kluster’s suitability** for a new application area (different to the Kluster Networking Challenge study). Reflect on the ethical requirements of each project:

**PROJECT 1:** “An old age psychiatry clinician is planning to evaluate the use of Kluster to support a social network of people with dementia and their carers. The researcher will recruit 20 carer-patient dyads, and will assess the effectiveness of Kluster in supporting the social interaction of the whole group.”

**PROJECT 2:** “A social work researcher is planning to evaluate the use of Kluster for a Restorative Justice Conference for young offenders (12-16-year-olds). This will involve the use of Kluster to facilitate a structured process where 4-5 offenders meet their victims, the victims’ families, and support people, along with trained mediators.”

**PROJECT 3:** “An international development researcher, in collaboration with Oxfam Bangladesh, is planning to evaluate the use of Kluster for a parenting support group in the Hathazari Upazila subdistrict, Chittagong, Bangladesh. In the group, a community health worker will support discussion of how parents can better support children’s social and educational needs.”

3. For each project, identify the **four most significant ethical concerns** (i.e. **not** simply operational concerns). These must be concerns that did not need to be addressed in the Kluster Networking Challenge study design. Describe each concern and propose a mitigation strategy for each. Use no more than **200 words** to describe each concern and its mitigation strategy (i.e., **2400 words** for the whole task).

#### What to Submit

Use the answer template (Excel Workbook): <https://tinyurl.com/KLUSTER-S2-2025-1A>, and submit your answers as a file named **"YOUR-STUDENT-ID-Assigment-1A.xlsx"**.

#### How Much to Write

Follow the maximum word limit stated above. The word count does not include spaces. Only words within the word limit will be marked.

## Task B (Week 3)

### “Finding Relevant Literature”

This assignment task evaluates your ability to find, assess, and explain the relevance of published research. These skills are essential for designing evidence-based research projects and understanding the current state of knowledge in the field of Information Technology.

In this task, you must search for research papers and patents published in two specific years, that relate to the topics listed below. The years you are required to focus on have been assigned according to your Student ID; these are specified in the table below. For example, if your **Student ID** is **36373701**, you should only look work published in **2006** and **2009**.

| From: Student ID | To: Student ID | Years       |
|------------------|----------------|-------------|
| 12892246         | 30956862       | 1990 & 2025 |
| 30956863         | 32449852       | 1991 & 2024 |
| 32449853         | 33443807       | 1992 & 2023 |
| 33443808         | 34458425       | 1993 & 2022 |
| 34458426         | 34713034       | 1994 & 2021 |
| 34713035         | 34866167       | 1995 & 2020 |
| 34866168         | 35195967       | 1996 & 2019 |
| 35195968         | 35275103       | 1997 & 2018 |
| 35275104         | 35376929       | 1998 & 2017 |

| From: Student ID | To: Student ID | Years       |
|------------------|----------------|-------------|
| 35376930         | 35478888       | 1999 & 2016 |
| 35478889         | 35581123       | 2000 & 2015 |
| 35581124         | 35649089       | 2001 & 2014 |
| 35649090         | 35722258       | 2002 & 2013 |
| 35722259         | 35834234       | 2003 & 2012 |
| 35834235         | 35965800       | 2004 & 2011 |
| 35965801         | 36216291       | 2005 & 2010 |
| 36216292         | 36373702       | 2006 & 2009 |
| 36373703         | 36698709       | 2007 & 2008 |

- For **each** of your **two assigned years**, you must find a total of **four relevant research papers** and **one relevant patent**. Therefore, in total you must find and submit eight papers and two patents. For **each year**, identify:
  - 2 systems papers**, that describe novel multi-party synchronous (i.e. real-time) video or audio collaborative systems.
  - 2 evaluation papers**, as follows:
    - one paper that includes system log analysis to evaluate a multi-party synchronous (real-time) video or audio collaborative system.
    - one paper that includes an evaluation of “group engagement” in a multi-party synchronous video or audio online collaborative system.
  - 1 patent** that describes an invention that you believe would be most relevant to a researcher intending to either; (i) commercialise Kluster (i.e. you should identify an existing feature of Kluster that has already been patented) or (ii) extend Kluster by adding new features (i.e. you should identify a patent for a feature that could be added to Kluster).
- Write a justification for including each paper and patent of no more than **150 words** (1500 words in total for 8 papers, and 2 patents). Be very careful to follow the formatting instructions provided in the spreadsheet. Incorrectly formatted responses will be penalised.

#### What to Submit

Use the answer template (Excel Workbook): <https://tinyurl.com/KLUSTER-S2-2025-1B>, and submit your answers as a file named **"YOUR-STUDENT-ID-Assignment-1B.xlsx"**.

#### How Much to Write

Follow the maximum word limit stated above. The word count does not include spaces. Only words within the word limit will be marked.

## Task C: Week 5 (Interviews)

### “Planning and Conducting a Research Interview”

This assessment task aims to evaluate how well you can plan and conduct a research interview, using topics related to people's experience of the Kluster Networking Challenge.

1. **PLAN YOUR INTERVIEW.** Develop an interview schedule for a semi-structured interview (minimum of 30 minutes) with another participant of the Kluster Networking Challenge that explores all the following sub-topics:
  - **Topic 1. Fidelity:** your interviewee's views on the similarities and differences between participating in an event in Kluster and in an in-person event in a physical space.
  - **Topic 2. Task Completion:** your interviewee's experiences of completing the Kluster Networking Challenge task (i.e. finding 6 team members).
  - **Topic 3: Interface Design:** your interviewee's views of Kluster's interface, Kluster's functionality, and their suggestions for how these both might be improved.
2. **PROVIDE INTERVIEW SLOTS.** Register at least two dates and times when you are available to be interviewed (on Zoom) by another student. Using [this form](#) (the availability form), add two 45-minute slots between 9.00 AM and 9.00 PM Thursday-Sunday, 11-14 September (do this by **11:55 PM Tuesday, 9 September**).
3. **BOOK AN INTERVIEW SLOT:** From **9.00 AM on Wednesday, 10 September**, you can book a slot to interview another student by selecting one of the times, dates, and students (captured in step 2 above). Use this “[Dashboard](#)” to find a time (not accessible until **Wednesday, 10 September**). You can then record your selection (and a Zoom link for the interview) using this [this form](#) (booking form), and you and your interviewee will receive a confirmation email.
4. **CONDUCT YOUR INTERVIEW.** Before the agreed interview time, ensure that both you and your interviewee have your **participant code**. You received this code when you took part in the Kluster Networking Challenge. [A template for the consent form is available here](#). Conduct the interview using Zoom and ensure that you record the session for transcription purposes. **Your interview must be at least 30 minutes long.**
5. **TRANSCRIBE YOUR INTERVIEW.** After completing the interview, transcribe the recording using a modified form of verbatim transcription, that is, transcribe everything that both you (the interviewer) and your interviewee say. Exclude non-verbal utterances such as "um", "ah", coughs, sneezes, etc. Be sure to **anonymise the transcript** using the participant codes for both **you** and **your interviewee**.

#### What to Submit

1. Use the answer template (Excel Workbook): <https://tinyurl.com/KLUSTER-S2-2025-1C>
2. Follow the formatting requirements specified in the answer template:
  - a. Add your questions to the “**Interview Plan**” sheet in the Excel Workbook.
  - b. Add your interview transcript to the “**Transcript**” sheet in the Excel workbook.
3. **Submit** the Workbook as a file named “**YOUR-STUDENT-ID-Assignment-1C.xlsx**”.
4. **Submit** the signed consent form as the file: “**YOUR-STUDENT-ID-CONSENT.pdf**”.
5. **Submit** an MP3 or MP4 audio file containing the un-edited recording of your interview as a file named: “**YOUR-STUDENT-ID-AUDIO.mp3**” (or “.mp4”)